

This Founder Sold His App for \$80M Doing Vibe Coding.

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Aakash Gupta

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How to Vibe Code a Million-Dollar Startup

Written by Aakash Gupta

Maor Shlomo sold his company for \$80 million cash.

He built most of it by vibe coding.

This is no longer theoretical. It's happening.

Anyone who says vibe coding can't lead to production-ready software is just telling on themselves. The latest Claude 4.5-Sonnet model in Claude Code or Cursor can generate production code.

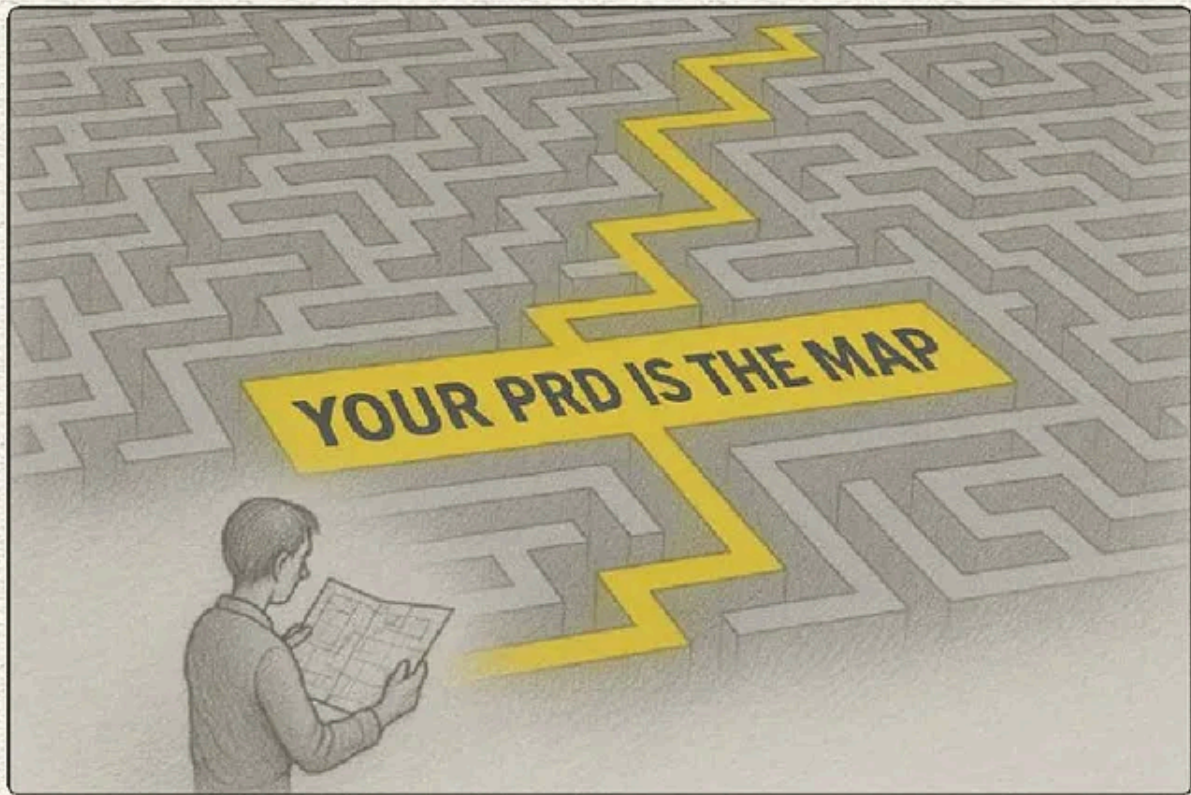
Not prototype code. Not demo code. Actual production code that scales.

Here's exactly how to do it.

Complete guide to production implementation.

Step 1: Find Your Idea (Start With a Real PRD)

Step 1 - Find Your Idea



Most builders jump into the maze without a map.
Smart ones write the route first

You can't vibe code without direction.

Write a proper PRD first. This is not optional.

Define:

- What problem you're solving
- How the metrics will work
- The user flows

Without this clarity, you'll vibe code yourself into a mess.

[Complete PRD guide here.](#)

Step 2: SaaS Template Foundation

Don't start from scratch.

Start with a strong SaaS template. You want authentication, database setup, deployment configured, and basic UI components ready.

If you start with bad vibe code, you'll have a fragile foundation that breaks under load.

A solid template gives you production-grade infrastructure from day one. Then you build your unique features on top.

Step 3: Data Modeling (The Step Everyone Skips)

People want to outsource this to AI. Big mistake.

This is the most critical step. With a bad data model, your app collapses when people actually use it.

Sketch out your data schema yourself. What entities exist? How do they relate? What queries will you run most often?

AI can help implement it. But you need to design it.

Step 4: Components & Visual Design

This is where you prevent your app from looking like every other vibe coded product.

Using Tailwind, define your design system clearly.

Colors. Typography. Spacing. Component patterns.

This gives the AI all the building blocks to build your app the way you want it, not generic SaaS template #47.

Details on design systems.

Step 5: Prototyping & Validation

Start with a prototyping tool to get a testing version fast.

Bolt, v0, or similar. Ship something clickable in hours.

Use this in discovery to nail down your core MVP UX.

Show it to potential users. Watch them interact with it. Learn what works and what doesn't.

[Complete prototyping guide.](#)

I cover tactics like this in my newsletter. [Join 195k+ PMs here.](#)

Step 6: Production Implementation

Now you're ready for construction mode.

Go from prototyping tool to Cursor + Claude Code.

Build out the full app. Real database. Real authentication. Real error handling. Real performance optimization.

This is where vibe coding shines. You describe what you want. The AI generates it. You review and refine.

You move 10x faster than traditional development while maintaining quality.

Step 7: CI/CD Pipeline

Set up automated deployment.

You're not manually pushing code like it's 2015.

GitHub Actions or Vercel make this easy. Every commit goes through tests, builds, and deploys automatically.

This catches bugs before users see them and keeps your deployment process clean.

Step 8: Security Essentials

Authentication. Rate limiting. API security.

The basics that keep you from getting hacked on day one.

Use established libraries.

Clerk or Auth.js for authentication. Don't roll your own. Follow best practices, not reinvent.

This is where you trust proven solutions instead of getting creative.

Step 9: Distribution

Ship it. Get it in front of users immediately.

Launch on Product Hunt. Post on X. Share in relevant communities.

The best validation is real people using it.

You can't vibe code product-market fit. You find it by shipping and iterating.

Watch how people actually use your product. Listen to what they struggle with. Fix the biggest problems. Ship updates.

This feedback loop is where you go from “working product” to “valuable product.”

Why This Changes Everything

Five years ago, taking an idea to production required:

- A technical co-founder or \$100K+ for developers

- 6–12 months of development time
- Constant back-and-forth on requirements
- High risk if the idea didn't work

Today, with vibe coding:

- You can build alone
- 2–4 weeks from idea to production
- Direct iteration based on your vision
- Low risk because you validate fast

Maor's \$80M exit proves this isn't just for demos. This is real products. Real users. Real businesses.

The barrier to building software just collapsed.

The Skill That Matters Now

This is becoming a critical skill for founders and PMs.

Not just understanding how to code. Understanding how to direct AI to build what you envision.

The best builders in 2025 won't be the best programmers. They'll be the people with the clearest vision who can translate that vision into working products using AI.

If you're a PM who can vibe code production software, you're 10x more valuable than a PM who can only write specs.

If you're a founder who can build your MVP yourself, you move faster than teams with full engineering departments.

This skill compounds fast.

Your Move

You can keep writing specs and waiting for engineers to build.

Or you can learn to vibe code and ship yourself.

The founders doing this are moving at incredible speed. Ideas to production in weeks. Multiple product experiments per month. Direct control over their vision.

Want to learn this approach? [Join 195k+ PMs reading my newsletter](#). I break down exactly how to build like this.

The future of building is here. Maor proved it works at scale. Now the question is whether you'll learn it or watch others ship faster than you.

• • •

Are you vibe coding to production? Drop a comment with what you're building and what tools you're using.

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Rahul Siddharth

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